

Republic of the Philippines
HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
Quezon City

NINETEENTH CONGRESS
Third Regular Session

HOUSE BILL No. **11308**



Introduced by Representative CAMILLE A. VILLAR

AN ACT
ENHANCING WORKERS' PROTECTION AND SKILLS DEVELOPMENT IN
THE COURSE OF JOB DISRUPTION DUE TO ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE
AND TECHNOLOGICAL ADVANCEMENTS IN THE DIGITAL ECONOMY,
AND FOR OTHER PURPOSES

Explanatory Note

Under the 1987 Philippine Constitution, the State affirms labor as a primary social economic force. It shall protect the rights of workers and promote their welfare.¹ The State shall afford full protection to labor, local and overseas, organized and unorganized, and promote full employment and equality of employment opportunities for all.²

Advanced technology including Artificial Intelligence and machine learning is changing the world at an unprecedented pace. As these changes accelerate, the future of work is shifting fundamentally and the ability to transition into new jobs is more critical than ever. The World Economic Forum's own research shows that 23% of all jobs will be changed by technology and automation by 2027, with 69 million new job roles expected to be created and 83 million job roles expected to be displaced. Almost a quarter of all workers face the challenge of ensuring they have the relevant skills to thrive in an increasingly digital global economy.³

To help workers and businesses adapt to the jobs of tomorrow, the World Economic Forum outlines four key pillars to smooth the pathway into successful

¹ Section 18, Article II, 1987 Philippine Constitution

² Section 3, Article XIII, 1987 Philippine Constitution

³ <https://www.weforum.org/stories/2024/10/jobs-skills-work-digital-economy/>

employment in the digital economy, namely: (1) reskilling and upskilling for new opportunities; (2) improving employee-employer matching; (3) worker safety nets and (4) multistakeholder collaboration to break through industry barriers.⁴

This bill aims to make workers adaptable to the rapid changing of times. It seeks to support workers at risk due to artificial intelligence or technological advancements, promote upskilling and reskilling, and facilitate their career transition in the digital economy.

This bill creates a National Task Force on Digital Economy Job Disruption (Task Force) that, among others, will establish an Early Warning System to identify industries at high risk of artificial intelligence or digital disruption and assess the potential impact on workers' employment. It will also establish a Workers' Adjustment Program (WAP) to provide financial assistance to workers affected by artificial intelligence or digital disruption, and develop a career transition support system.

In view of the aforementioned considerations, the approval of this measure is urgently requested.


CAMILLE A. VILLAR

⁴ Ibid

Republic of the Philippines
HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
Quezon City

NINETEENTH CONGRESS
Third Regular Session

HOUSE BILL No. **11308**

Introduced by Representative CAMILLE A. VILLAR

AN ACT
ENHANCING WORKERS' PROTECTION AND SKILLS DEVELOPMENT IN
THE COURSE OF JOB DISRUPTION DUE TO ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE
AND TECHNOLOGICAL ADVANCEMENTS IN THE DIGITAL ECONOMY,
AND FOR OTHER PURPOSES

Be it enacted by the Senate and the House of Representatives of the Philippines in Congress assembled:

Section 1. *Short Title* – This Act shall be known as the “*Workers’ Protection and Skills Development in the Digital Economy Act*”.

Sec 2. *Declaration of Policy* - It is the policy of the State to ensure the welfare and protection of workers, recognizing their vital role in nation-building. The State shall provide support for workers at risk due to artificial intelligence or technological advancements, promote upskilling and reskilling, and facilitate career transition in the digital economy.

Sec. 3. *Creation of the National Task Force on Digital Economy Job Disruption* - A National Task Force on Digital Economy Job Disruption (Task Force) shall be created, composed of the Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE), the Department of Information and Communications Technology (DICT), the Department of Trade and Industry (DTI), the Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA), and other pertinent agencies, to develop and implement programs and initiatives related to this Act.

Sec. 4. *Early Warning System* - The Task Force shall establish an Early Warning System to identify industries at high risk of artificial intelligence or digital disruption and assess the potential impact on workers' employment. This system shall provide vital information for preparing intervention measures and updating policies.

Sec. 5. *Safety Nets and Financial Assistance* - A Workers' Adjustment Program (WAP) shall be established to provide financial assistance to workers affected by artificial intelligence or digital disruption. The WAP shall include wage compensation, unemployment benefits, and temporary income support.

Sec. 6. *Upskilling and Reskilling Initiative* - The Task Force, in collaboration with the private sector, shall design and implement a comprehensive upskilling and reskilling program focused on digital skills and emergent technologies. These programs shall include:

- a. Digital skills assessments for workers to identify opportunities for skill development;
- b. Development of industry-specific training and certification programs, which cater to the needs and requirements of the digital economy; and
- c. Financial assistance and scholarships for workers seeking to upgrade or acquire new skills through technical and vocational training, short-term courses, or formal education.

Sec. 7. *Support for Career Transition* - The Task Force shall develop a career transition support system to help workers find new opportunities in the digital economy, which shall include:

- a. Career counseling and job placement services;
- b. Establishment of an online platform to connect workers with job opportunities, training programs, and mentorships; and
- c. Collaboration with employers and industry groups to develop strategies for the seamless integration of displaced workers in the rapidly changing digital economy.

Sec. 8. *Stakeholder Consultation and Collaboration* - The Task Force shall maintain regular consultation and cooperation with stakeholders, including labor unions, employers' organizations, and industry associations, to ensure that the policies and programs are effective and shall meet the needs of workers and businesses.

Sec. 9. *Annual Report to Congress* - The Task Force shall submit an annual report on the implementation of this Act, the status of displaced workers, and the progress of skills development and job transition programs.

Sec. 10. *Funding*. - The necessary funding for the implementation of this Act shall be sourced from the DOLE, DICT, DTI, TESDA's share in the annual General Appropriations Act (GAA).

Sec. 11. *Implementing Rules and Regulations*. - The DOLE, DICT, DTI, TESDA, and the other relevant instrumentalities and stakeholders, shall develop the implementing rules and regulations, within sixty (60) days from the effectivity of this Act.

Sec. 12. *Separability Clause*. - Any portion or provisions of this Act that may be declared unconstitutional or invalid shall not have the effect of nullifying the other portions or provisions hereof as long as such remaining portions or provisions can still subsist and be given effect in their entirety.

Sec. 13. *Repealing Clause*. - All laws, presidential decrees, executive orders, memoranda, circulars, and other issuances, or parts thereof, which are inconsistent with the Act, are hereby repealed or modified accordingly.

Sec. 14. *Effectivity Clause*. - This Act shall take effect fifteen (15) days after its publication in at least two (2) newspapers of general circulation.

Approved,